PRELUDE XXI

WHEN every natural melodic expression suggested by bars 1-8 (especially bar 2, the crossing of parts in bar 3, and every ornament) has been satisfactorily mastered, the player should let nothing induce him to hurry the *tempo* thus determined. In the middle of bar 8 the bass starts a second theme in the dominant, which the treble imitates at cross-accent. Three-part writing is abandoned for the next nine bars, except that it is ambiguously implicit in the cross-hand passages. These undoubtedly here imply a harpsichord with two manuals; not because that is in any way necessary for ordinary cross-hand devices, but because it would make a vital difference between bars 13-14 and bars 15-16, the tone-colours of the manuals differing as obviously as green from gold. The player must not allow this passage to hurry him; he must enjoy the widespread fourth-beat *arpeggios* like a violinist. And when the three-part writing is resumed, he should as soon dream of hurrying the theme in bars 19-20 as of hurrying it when Beethoven uses it in a radically slower *tempo* in the *Benedictus* of the Mass in D. In short, it is of the utmost importance to conceive a large and quiet idea of this great binary movement in a *tempo* which, without lacking in gentle flow, will not be taken by surprise at the four-part cadence in bar 48. (This may require a slight *ritardando*, leading, as it does, to the return.) A considerable climax is built up from bar 70 onwards. The pause in bar 76 (preceded by a suitable *ritardando*) will help the player to make his climax without breaking the reflective mood; and he can keep the ensuing long run alive without losing the deliberate *tempo*, by clearly bringing out its dialogue-aspects as a development of the first theme which has been so constant a topic, both direct and (as first in the bass of bar 3) inverted. And, after all, the Prelude ends quietly with a recapitulation in the tonic of bars 28-32. The flat supertonic (or " Neapolitan sixth ") colour of the last bar but two should alone suffice to protect the piece from voluble misinterpretation.

Our text follows the British Museum autograph, except in one or two slight corrections from the Altnikol MSS.

FUGUE XXI

THE slurs given by Bach to bars 3-4 of the Subject are, of course, to be supplied on all appearances of that figure. The remainder of the texture will be a flowing *legato* throughout. The starred readings are those of the British Museum autograph. For various reasons the Altnikol and other pupils' MSS. are to be taken as often representing later views; but there is no harm in choosing one version for one passage and another for another. In bars 5-6 the probable reason for altering the excellent crotchet counterpoint was to avoid any anticipatory resemblance to the new Triple Counterpoint combination reserved for the section following bar 32. In bar 38 the quaver rest, instead of the low E♭, is admirably to the purpose in isolating the important and extremely simple Third Subject from merely episodic counterpoint by avoiding a sequential

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BWV 890. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
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reproduction of its last note, the low F in bar 36. The reading is, therefore, here given in the main text. In bar 78 Prout's commentary on the autograph is decisive for C, as against B♭ for the last quaver. The non-autograph readings, too important to be suppressed and too divergent to combine on one stave with the text, are as follows: Bars 5-6, middle voice:



; bar 19, treble:



; bars 88-90:



This last is interesting as showing a humorous attempt to preserve three-part writing while smuggling in the chord as an *arpeggio*, as at the end of the two-part E minor Fugue in Book I. But here, even in the leisurely *tempo* this Fugue may well bear, there is hardly time thus to spread the chord; the autograph reading is more natural, both as regards the chord (which the player may crisply break like a violin chord) and as regards the dialogue.

The quiet *tempo*, about that of Bach's menuets, suggested already by this incident, is confirmed by the most obvious formal feature of the piece—viz., the close of the first section with a four-bar cadence-phrase in the dominant (bars 29-32) reproduced in the tonic at the end (bars 90-93). The homophonic crotchet bass should be played with the Bebung touch—viz., the repeated notes nearly tied: 

From bar 32 the Subject is combined with two others in a Triple Counterpoint, there having hitherto been no Countersubject. Of the new themes, the second is obvious in the treble, with its fresh rhythm, its rising sequences, and its suspensions; but the simple third theme in the bass, consisting of the four notes A, B♭, C, F, is not less important, and is well represented throughout the rest of the Fugue, only once losing its first note (which would have been got into bar 55 if other imitative links had permitted), and at its final appearance (bars 80-86) combining with the others at a different point and duplicating itself in a sequence. It will always demand bringing out specially distinctly, being perfectly transparent to the contrasted movements of the others. The combination is not an ordinary Triple Counterpoint, for its permutations produce a different set of harmonies and key-positions each time, being inverted in the twelfth and fourteenth, as well as the octave. The effect at bars 40-44 is particularly characteristic, especially when the third theme is duly brought out.